INSTITUTIONAL COURSE SYLLABUS TEMPLATE

Course Code: PDS002	Course Title: Personal Development Skills 2
Course Instructor: Ms. Tiffani Nutter	Email: tnutter@psu.edu.sa
Credit Hours: 1	Course Location: N412
Scheduled Office Hours: By appointment	
Office Location: W235	
Co-Requisite: None	Prerequisite: PDS001
On Campus	

Mission Statement

The PYP is committed to achieving an effective transition of high school graduates into qualified vibrant learners who have the level of proficiency in academia necessary to participate fully as PSU students. Using the latest technological advances and scientific instruction, we seek to develop numerical, linguistic and study skills necessary to make the transition to college life. We are committed to delivering well-rounded individuals who have a passion for learning.

Vision

The Prep. Year Program (PYP) aspires to ensure that high school graduates become successful participants in the PSU community by nurturing the mind, the spirit and the body.

I. Course Description:

The main purpose of this course is to help students to continue to make the adjustment from high school to academic life at university level. Core skills covered in this course include Critical thinking, problem solving, information literacy, understanding growth mindset, stress management and presentation skills. This course will be delivered **on campus** through the course management system Moodle and Mac-Graw Hill- Connect. You will use your PSU account to login to the course from the Moodle Login Page. If you have not activated your PSU account, please visit or contact IT to do so. In Moodle, you will access course materials, participate in discussions, submit assignments, see announcements, and access resources. On Mac-Graw Hill-Connect site you will complete learning activities assigned for each chapter during online sessions or as homework. You can also view the e-book and instructional videos available. At designated times throughout the semester, we will participate in a group-paced activity using Moodle and meet live sessions and/or alternative Internet-based technologies. Activities will consist of chat, discussion forums, and email. The course involves applied, activity-based collaboration and therefore relies heavily on a team approach to learning

II. Course Learning Outcomes: (A summary of intended learning outcomes of the course in each domain of learning). On the successful completion of this course, students will be able to demonstrate the following:

Skills	Course Learning Outcomes
Knowledge & Understanding	**CLO** 1: Describe the steps in decision making and problem-solving processes.
Skills	**CLO 2**: Analyse a given problem using critical and creative thinking CLO 3: Explain the criteria for choosing a career and course major **CLO 4**: Illustrate the application of information literacy skills to organize materials and sources for the research component of projects.
Values	**CLO 5**: Demonstrate collaboration and communication in pair and group activities

III. Tentative Weekly Course Schedule: (Should mention the specific course topics to be covered within the semester) *May change to accommodate guest presenters & student needs*.

WEEK	UNIT/ TOPIC	CLO(s) alignment	STUDENT TASKS (assignments, readings, exams, quizzes, presentations, etc…)	Number of Contact hours
1 January 14 - 20	Introduction & orientations to the course		Course syllabus, LMS, McGraw-Hill Connect; policies, etc.	2
2 January 21 - 27	**Module 1: Making Good Decisions** (pp. 273-296) ● Overview of decision making ● Free writing process ● Journal reflections: decision crossroads	1 & 2	● SMART book ● Connect activities	2
3 January 28 – Feb. 3	● Fact vs. Opinion ● Case study: left holding the lease	1 & 2	● Connect activities	2

4 February 4 - 10	• Critical thinking process • Analyzing & evaluating information	1 & 2	• Discussion forum #1 (5%)	1
5 February 11- 17	• Problem solving process • Overview of problem solving • Problem solving style	1 & 2	▪ Connect activities	2
6 February 18 – 24 *(22nd Saudi Founding day)*	**Module 2 : Choosing Your Course & Major (pp. 211-239)** • Overview of career exploration process • How do you choose your courses? • Identify major attractions	3	▪ SMART book ▪ Connect Activity	2
7 February 25- March 2	• Choosing major • Focusing on your interest • Preparing for Job interview • Revising Resume	3	▪ Connect activity ▪ Discussion Forum #2	2
8 March 3 -9	• Revising Cover letters Personality, career, interest • Presentation	3	▪ Connect activity	2
9 March 10 -16	▪ Compiling career exploration essay ▪ Take all career assessments on LMS Reflect on assessment results	3	▪ Written assignment	2
10 -13 **March 17 -14 April**	**Eid Al-Fitr Holiday** **17 March - 14 April** **No classes**			
14 April 15 - 20	**Module 3: Technology & Information Competency (pp. 241-272)** • Overview of information literacy skill • Information literacy & critical thinking ▪ How to avoid Plagiarism and give Reference by using APA style	2 & 4	SMART book Connect activities	2
15	• Work the web: information • Using Email netiquette	2 & 4		2

April 21 - 27	• Communicating with Instructors • Case study: The missing file • **Major Exam**		Connect activities	
16 April 28 – 4 May *(May 2nd extended holiday)*	• Reflection: Can I live without technology • Review questions	2 & 4	Connect activities	2
17 May 5 - 11	Presentation	4 & 5	Group project (10%)	2
18 May 12 - 18	**Module 4: Test taking Skill** (pp. 120-144) • Overview of test taking • Measuring your test-taking style • Dealing with test-anxiety • test preparation checklist take attest taking test	1 & 2	*SMART book* *Connect activities*	2
19 May 19 - 23	Consultation; Feedback & Exit survey		*Course exit survey* *Students check grades*	

IV. Student Assessment & Teaching Strategies:

Assessment Task (Indicate the kind of assessment tasks to be used to measure student learning in each of the learning domains. Example: quiz, oral examination, group work, etc.).
Teaching Strategies: (Please indicate the teaching and student activities to be used to develop the kinds of learning involved in each learning domain. Also, research specialized Information about Best Teaching Practices for the particular course/field).

Domain	Assessment Task	Teaching Strategy
Knowledge	Assignment, quiz, discussions	Group teaching (F2F/online Lectures) Class Discussion Student-led learning (e.g. discussion forums) Integrating Technology (e.g. LMS, Connect
Skills	Assignment, discussion forum, Quiz	Group teaching (F2F/online Lectures)

		Class Discussion Student-led learning (e.g. discussion forums) Integrating Technology (e.g. LMS, Connect
Competencies	Presentation, discussion forums	Class Discussion Problem based learning (assignments, projects) Student-led learning (e.g. discussion forums) Active learning (group work case study, problem-solving exercises)

V. Course Requirements [Whatever tasks and assignments you include in your course should be aligned with the specified learning outcomes (final learning, skills, knowledge, attitudes, and values the students leave the course with) you have defined and specified earlier.
These requirements should be consistent with the Course Specification on file in the particular department.]

VI. Schedule of Assessment (Specify the schedule/date of assessment & proportion of assessment, attach related rubrics for each assessment if applicable. For examples of rubrics, visit www.irubrics.com . The schedule should be consistent with the academic calendar. Any significant changes should be avoided. If significant changes are made, academic leaders should be informed in writing, and students should be given a new schedule of assessment table).

Assessment	Assessment Task	Week Due	Proportion of Final Assessment
1	Major Exam	15 (tentative)	30 %
2	Discussion Forums	4 & 7	5%
3	Presentation (group)	8	10%
4	Online activity (In class or homework)	Throughout/All weeks	36% (4 modules)
5	Written assignment	9	14%

VII. Learning Resources

A. References - Course Book: P.O.W.E.R Learning: Strategies for Success in College and Life, 9th ed. by Robert Feldman; © 2023

B. Facilities Required – lecture room (Face-to-Face); Moodle; McGraw-Hill Connect access code; laptop/tablet, etc.

C. Digital Tools – The use of digital tools will support a variety of methods for the teaching and learning strategies across all disciplines. Each course needs to utilize a variety of digital tools like the Coursera Platform, the Publisher's online platforms, MOODLE, or any type of EDTECH tools (Kahoot, Edpuzzle, etc.) that will be used for all online education experiences at PSU. This will support the institution's digital transformation initiative.

D. Learning Management System – LMS using "Moodle" is required; items such as syllabus, course materials, assignments, rubrics, and announcements will be delivered through Moodle.

E. Writing and Tutoring Center – Students are highly advised to use the Writing and Tutoring Center's academic services by booking tutoring/writing appointments through the **booking system:** (https://psu.mywconline.net/)

VIII. Classroom Policies

Plagiarism policy: "Plagiarism is representing, intentionally or unintentionally, the words or ideas of another as one's own work without correctly acknowledging the source, in any educational setting. It is the responsibility of the student to learn and use the correct methods of avoiding plagiarism in each class."

Deliberate plagiarism is an extremely serious offense that may result in failing the course. Plagiarism includes not only copying from a published source or using internet materials without appropriate acknowledgment, but also presenting another student's work as your own. If I find plagiarism in any essay or assignment, the assignment will receive a zero grade for that paper. If it happens twice, you will receive an F for the course.

Academic Integrity: You are encouraged to study together and to discuss information and concepts covered in class with other students. You can give "consulting" help to or receive "consulting" help from such students. However, this should never involve one student having possession of a copy of all or part of work done by someone else. Should copying occur, both the student who copied work from another student and the student who gave material to be copied will both automatically receive a zero on the assignment.

Use of AI Tools: This course requires you to complete various assignments that assess your understanding and application of the course content. You are expected to do your own work and cite any sources you use properly. You are not allowed to use any artificial intelligence (AI) tools, such as chatbots, text generators, or solvers, to complete any part of your assignments. Using AI tools is considered a form of academic dishonesty and will *result in a zero grade* for the assignment and possible disciplinary action. If you have any questions about what constitutes acceptable use of AI tools, please consult with the instructor before submitting your work.

Attendance Policy: The University attendance policy will be strictly followed. In this course, the absence of 8 hours or results in a Denied Notice (DN). (Refer to the student regulation handbook for further details.)
Please Note: IT IS THE SOLE RESPONSIBILITY OF THE STUDENT TO KEEP SATISFYING their level of attendance. Otherwise, a "DN" grade will be granted automatically during any time in the semester without any notice from the e-register system.

Makeup Exam: No make-up exams will be allowed except for university accepted documents. (Refer to the student regulation handbook for further details.). You can also see acceptable excuses at the end of this document.

*Homework Submission Policy***:** All homework assignments must be submitted by the specified deadline, as mentioned in the course schedule. Late submissions will not be accepted unless you have a valid and documented reason, such as a medical emergency or prior approval from the instructor. In the event of technical difficulties or issues with the submission platform, it is your responsibility to contact the instructor as soon as possible and provide evidence of the problem.

IX. My Assumptions (Optional)
This is a section where the instructor can communicate his or her personal assumptions and/or biases regarding the course content to set it off from other similar courses and other instructors. Does the instructor have a unique operational definition for some of the core course concepts? What principles and/or beliefs about either the content or how to effectively learn the content held by the instructor would be helpful for the students to know upfront?

By registering for this course, I acknowledge that I have read and understand the Academic Integrity Statement and its consequences.

Appendix: Prep. Year Program: Makeup Exam Accepted Excuses

Acceptable Excuses

- Car accident with a detailed Najm report mentioning the driver's information, and date/time of the accident.
- Hospital admission in a recognized hospital with a medical report signed by the hospital Director.
- Death of a close (immediate relative-first degree) family member. The student should submit a copy of the Death Certificate to Student Affairs.
- Caring for a sick family member in an emergency. A justification letter must be provided.
- One-day sick leave from a recognized hospital with the reason clearly mentioned.
- Force majeure – Credible evidence necessary

Note: All justifications and excuses must be submitted within 10 days of the exam/assessment/quiz/assignment date

Unacceptable Excuses

- Excuses from medical centers, and small clinics.
- Oversleeping
- Tiredness
- Bad weather
- Alarm clock not working - Not sure about the exam time
- Traffic jam
- Traveling or changing a flight schedule
- Medical appointment
- Migraine, fever, headache, etc.
- Commuting
- Attending ceremonies: wedding, meeting, activities…etc.
- Family issues
- Dental emergencies